

DaemonCore Academy DCCO 1 Framework Guide

Candidate readiness, evidence policy, independent review, and credential boundaries

DOCUMENT	RELEASE	STATUS	PUBLISHED
DC-DOC-900-F	9.0.0	Official	14 September 2026

Intended audience Prospective candidates, reviewers, instructors, and credential administrators

DCCO-1 is the planned DaemonCore Certified Cyber Operator vendor credential. The desktop can evaluate readiness and export a signed candidate dossier, but it cannot issue a credential, badge, certificate, or public verification record.

Current status

The DCCO-1 certification program is in development and is not currently accepting applications unless DaemonCore Apps separately announces that the independent review and issuer services are operational. A local eligibility result or exported candidate dossier is not certification.

DCCO-1 is intended as a vendor professional credential. It is not government accreditation, a degree, a state license, an authorization to test systems, or a guarantee of employment.

Published readiness policy

Requirement	Threshold
Practical lessons	20 passes at 80 percent or better
Independent missions	5 sealed completions
Web Forge	8 accepted conditions
Enterprise Forge	8 accepted cases
Drills	4 passes
Principal capstones	2 passes at 80 percent or better

Candidate dossier

When every local readiness requirement is met, the application can bind the candidate's protected identity, device-key fingerprint, evidence references, policy version, and application version into a signed dossier. Editing a bound claim breaks verification.

The dossier is an application artifact for future independent review. It does not contain an issuer decision and must never be displayed as a certificate.

Dossier element	Purpose
Candidate identity	Connects evidence to the named applicant
Device public key	Verifies the local dossier signature
Policy version	Identifies the standard evaluated
Evidence references	Points reviewers to qualifying local outcomes
Digest and signature	Detects modification after export

Requirements before issuance

A production credential program requires documented identity verification, controlled exam delivery, independent review, issuer-key separation, privacy terms, support, appeals, revocation, renewal, and a public verification service. Those controls must be deployed and tested together before DaemonCore markets issued credentials.

Framework relationship

DaemonCore maps selected Living Range objectives to NICE Framework Components v2.2.0 for transparent curriculum alignment. That relationship is independent and does not imply NIST or CISA endorsement, accreditation, approval, or certification.

Reference	Use in DaemonCore
NICE work roles	Describe the kind of cybersecurity work represented
Task statements	Connect objectives to observable work
Knowledge and skill statements	Describe capabilities exercised by the scenario
DaemonCore evidence policy	Defines local completion and dossier readiness

Document control

This document describes DaemonCore Academy 9.0.0. When application behavior and this guide differ, stop the affected workflow and consult the release notes or support channel before continuing. Product and framework names belonging to third parties are used descriptively and do not imply endorsement.

Field	Value
Owner	DaemonCore Apps
Release	9.0.0
Classification	Public product documentation
Review trigger	Material product, policy, or credential-status change